as if we are viewing the artist and the elements around him in motion. There is no clear rendering of the Wall as sculpture here, in Tajiri's view or in the logics informing the border area. The final images offer no denouement for the project or the structure. The fact that Tajiri rides the train around this section to view the Wall signals the difficulty of traversing this part of the border zone, its obliteration of the natural form of the city, and the artist's own desire to move beyond it. Perhaps this also marks an attempt to satisfy his interest in a structure without a perceptible end. The Wall here is physically more distant from Tajiri than it has been previously, but nonetheless it is shown as interconnected, staggered, and deliberate. With the inner core of the city behind him, Tajiri moves through the outer region of the allied sectors. Overall, his photographs exist as fragments, but as a study in sculpture they conjure or approach a vision for critical reflection. The artist varies his distance, perspective, and approach. As an artist in double exile, he finds the border to be a threshold, a productive space to observe and experiment, and where he withholds a final place of closure or return.

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Tajiri's 1969–70 survey of the Berlin Wall was a study in the border's standardizing form and simmering geopolitical surroundings. Other than the official images made by GDR border guards for private record-keeping and their commanding officers, Tajiri's study happens to be the only known comprehensive record of the wall system as the structure in construction, a study in the sprawling divided city's architecture of the period.[42] But Tajiri did not arrive at any one final outcome for his project. As opposed to most of his physically constructed sculptures, which once installed were considered complete, his conceptual photographic and sculptural study allowed him to rework his raw materials and to continue tinkering with his image archive of the Wall.

Despite immense efforts, the Wall's architectural evolution was not finished during this stage of revision. Although there was a major overhaul in the late 1960s, the GDR leadership decided to proceed with another redesign several years later. As Tajiri's images attest, after the prefabricated concrete slabs were installed, they could not escape their shaky foundations and difficult-to-manage standardization, resulting in further need for extensive repair. Plans for the fourth generation, Grenzmauer 75, were released in 1975, with construction beginning the following year. The iconic